

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday April 2, 2020

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors
Meeting #26, April 2, 2020

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom) beginning at 16:00 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (9/11): Francesco Cesarini, Benoît Chesneau, Maxim Fedorov, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Kenneth Lundin, Miriam Pena Villanueva, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, and Alistair Woodman.

Also present were: Bryan Paxton and Johnny Winn from the marketing WG.

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #25 held on March 19, 2020. Unanimously approved..

2. Intermediate actions: none
3. Quick treasury update: We have \$169K in the bank. Only change since last meeting was 2 new yearly and one lifetime membership payment. Sebastian still needs to resend the invoice to TI Tokyo.
4. Annual board election: Fred presented the results: Francesco, Fred, Sebastian, and Alistair were all re-elected into cohort C (which will be electable again in 2023). 68 members (representing 63% of the total voting eligible membership) voted in the election. Lessons learned: WildApricot poll worked well. We need to keep closer tab on who is eligible to vote because of “sweat equity” and make sure that they are (at least) basic members in WildApricot (so that they can be given voting rights in the system). Probably send out the results to everyone at the same time / before publishing to the website.

Next step will be to have an internal vote for the board positions (chair, secretary, and treasurer). Fred and Peer will try to put together a proposal for next meeting.

5. Board insurance: Alistair presented the offer (highlights: it has coverage for up to a million dollars, it includes legal counsel for board members). The suggested starting date for coverage is April 15. No questions or comments were raised. We will go ahead with this offer.
6. Benoit presented proposal for specific instructions for working groups how they should report their activities to the board (and members). The purpose is to improve communication and to increase transparency. The general comment is that this is a good idea. Benoit, Fred, and Kenneth agreed to form a task force to complete a proposal for upcoming board meeting.
7. Discussion on how to get more members involved to help out with foundation work and grow the community. A good example is the website, Bryan Paxton showed the to do list for the site, a lot of work to do and not enough people to help out. There is general agreement on that one of the biggest hurdles is “communication”, as an example: different working groups communicate in different ways, and there is no way for an outsider to see where the activity is. Another comment was that some members are “rubbed the wrong way by first paying for membership and then asked to also contribute work”.

Suggestions on how we can improve: at the very least somehow publish the list of work items that needs to be done, so that people can see what is needed. (In the case of the website the natural way would be to make them GitHub issues).

Another suggestion was to institute a “bounty program”, an easy way to attach a “price tag” to open items, making it possible for people to do the work and claim the bounty (need to be a low barrier for payout, while at the same time have an efficient review process to make sure that the work is done according to intent). There was a general sense that the bounty concept is worth looking into. Some comments: the board should probably make a budget ahead of time to make a fixed allocation for bounties (and other forms of payments such as stipends). We need to look into tax and liability and other implications for a non-profit to do payouts in this manner. Interested in helping out and investigating how to set up a bounty program: Peer, Bryan, Johnny, Sebastian, and Alistair.

8. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:01 UTC.

Dated April 2, 2020

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo